

Mealtime Management Policy

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE [REDACTED]	NEXT REVIEW [REDACTED]	OWNER [REDACTED]	APPROVED BY [REDACTED]
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PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy explains how [REDACTED] identifies participants who need mealtime management, ensures their needs are assessed by qualified health practitioners and set out in a mealtime management plan, trains workers to prepare and provide safe and enjoyable meals, and manages risks such as choking and chronic health conditions.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [REDACTED] to apply the Mealtime Management NDIS Practice Standard. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [REDACTED] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[REDACTED] is committed to ensuring that:

- each participant requiring mealtime management receives meals that are nutritious and of a texture appropriate to their individual needs, appropriately planned and prepared in an environment and manner that meets their needs and preferences and protects their privacy, dignity and safety.

3. Identification and assessment

[REDACTED] identifies each participant who requires mealtime management. With the participant's consent, their individual needs are assessed by a Qualified Health Practitioner, including comprehensive assessment of nutrition and swallowing and of seating and positioning for eating and drinking, resulting in a mealtime management plan that outlines their needs for swallowing, eating and drinking. Assessments and plans are reviewed at least annually, in accordance with the practitioner's advice, or sooner if needs change or difficulty is observed. With consent, the participant is involved in developing their plan.

4. Worker training and safe meals

Workers who provide mealtime management understand each relevant participant's needs and the steps to take if a safety incident occurs during a meal, such as coughing or choking. The Qualified Health Practitioner or another suitably qualified person trains workers to prepare and provide safe meals that would reasonably be expected to be enjoyable, to prepare and check texture-modified foods and fluids against the plan, and to proactively manage emerging and chronic health risks related to mealtime difficulties. Each participant's plan is available and easily accessible wherever mealtime management is provided.

5. Menu planning and food safety

[redacted] undertakes effective planning to develop menus with each participant so they receive nutritious, enjoyable meals reflecting their preferences and informed choice and any practitioner recommendations in their plan, and so that chronic health risks (swallowing difficulties, diabetes, anaphylaxis, food allergies, obesity or being underweight) are proactively managed. Meals for participants requiring mealtime management are stored safely and in accordance with health standards, can be identified as meals for a particular participant, and can be differentiated from meals not to be provided to that participant. Hydration and nutrition guidance and food safety, storage and preparation procedures apply.

6. Risk management

The plan and the worker training plan identify risks and the actions and escalations required, including [redacted]'s internal reporting and any reporting requirements within the participant's treating team.

7. Definitions

[redacted]
[redacted], ABN [redacted].

Client

A client of [redacted], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[redacted], and other key management personnel involved in [redacted] from time to time.

Principal

[redacted].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [redacted].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [redacted].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [redacted], including the Principal.

Qualified Health Practitioner

An AHPRA-registered health practitioner appropriately qualified and competent in assessing and developing an individual mealtime management plan — for example a registered nurse, dietitian, speech pathologist or general practitioner.

Representative

A person nominated by the participant to be told about matters affecting them, or a person with a connection to and concern for the participant (a partner, close relative, attorney under an enduring power of attorney, appointed guardian or substitute decision-maker).

8. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Mealtime Management Plan · Client Support Plan · Client Intake Form · Incident Management and Reporting Policy · Human Resources Management Policy · Legislation Register · Policy

Register.

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	
Approval date	
Next scheduled review	
Version	1.0